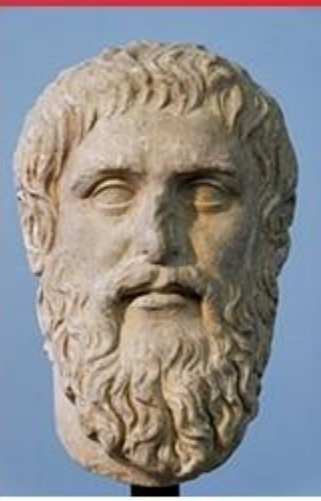
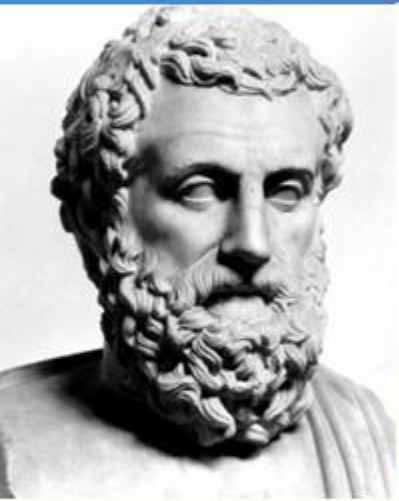


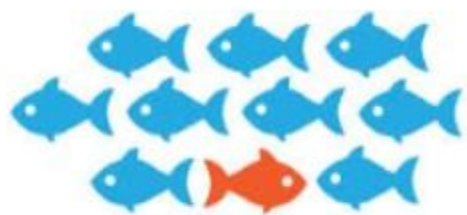
ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



MODULE - 2

**NATURE & SCOPE
OF ETHICS**

ETHICS IS NOT ...

**1 Following culturally accepted norms:**

While some cultures are and remain ethical, others may become corrupt or blind to certain ethical concerns (practice of Sati in some sections of society between 15th and 18th century).

2 Same as feelings: Although feelings provide important information for our ethical choices, some people may feel bad when they do something wrong while others may feel happy.

Feelings and accepted norms are not same as ethics.

ETHICS IS NOT ...



3 **Following the law:** Although a good system of law does incorporate many ethical standards, law can cross the ethical boundaries and can become ethically corrupt, as witnessed in some totalitarian regimes.

4 Usually something that is considered by many people as being **necessary** in order for them to conduct their everyday activities in a satisfactory manner.

Ethics applies to everyone regardless of one's religious affiliation.

WHAT IS ETHICS?



'Ethics' or 'moral philosophy' is the systematic philosophical study of morality.

- 1 A branch of philosophy that involves systematizing, defending, and recommending concepts of right and wrong conduct.
- 2 Seeks to resolve questions of human morality by defining concepts such as good and evil, right and wrong, virtue and vice, justice and crime.
- 3 Concerned with questions of how people ought to act, and the search for a definition of right conduct and the good life.

Right conduct: The one causing the greater good.

Good life: A life worth living or is satisfying and happy.

USES OF ETHICS



1 Ethics provides us with a framework that we can use to find our way through difficult issues.

2 Using this framework, people who are arguing a moral issue can look for common ground between their opinions and may even resolve their problem.

3 Ethics may not always show the right answer to moral problems, but can eliminate confusion and clarify the issues by giving right choices.

Ethics covers the dilemmas: moral decisions - good or bad; our rights and responsibilities; how to live a good life; the language of right and wrong.



IS ETHICS A SCIENCE?



Ethics is both theoretical and practical!

1 Ethics is a **rational science** because its principles are deduced by human's reason from the objects that concern the free will.

2 It is a science since it is a **set or body of reasoned truths** organised in a logical order and having its specific material and formal objects.

3 At the same time, **inherently it is an art** by which humans may live uprightly or comfortably (to right reason).

*It is a **normative/regulative science** because it regulates and directs human's life and gives the right orientation to one's existence.*

OBSERVE



A defence lawyer's **morals** may tell him that murder is unpardonable and that murderers should be punished, but his **ethics** as a professional lawyer, require him to defend his client to the best of his abilities, even if he knows that the client is guilty.



As active euthanasia is illegal in India, a doctor may not euthanize a patient, even at the patient's request, as per **ethical** standards for health professionals. However, the same doctor may personally believe in a patient's right to die, as per the doctor's own **morality**.

*These situations clearly demonstrate that **Morals** are not essentially same as **Ethics**.*

WHAT IS MORALITY?



- 1 'Morality' is the **normative** moral code or codes of **behaviour acceptable or prohibited** within a particular group at a particular time.
- 2 Its can be a body of standards or principles **derived from** a code of conduct from a particular philosophy, religion or culture, or a standard that a person believes should be universal.
- 3 People or entities that are indifferent to right and wrong are considered **amoral**, while those who do evil acts are considered **immoral**.

Normative: *establishing, relating to or deriving from a standard or norm, especially of behaviour.*

MORALS VS ETHICS

MORALS

It is the object of the enquiry.

Statements and rules.

Framed and designed by the group, there is no option to think and choose.

Usually consistent, although can change if an individual's beliefs change.

CRITERIA

RELATIONSHIP

EXPRESSED AS

ACCEPTABILITY

FLEXIBILITY

ETHICS

It is the field of the enquiry.

More abstract form.

Governed by professional and legal guidelines within a particular time and place.

Tend to be consistent within a certain context, but can vary between contexts.

MORALS VS ETHICS

MORALS

A Moral Person although perhaps bound by a higher convention, may choose to follow a code of ethics as it would apply to a system.

Morals are the beliefs of the individual or group as to what is right or wrong.

CRITERIA

THE GRAY AREA

FINALLY ...

ETHICS

A person strictly following Ethical Principles may not have any Morals at all. Similarly, one could violate Ethical Principles within a given system of rules in order to maintain Moral integrity.

Ethics are the guiding principles which help the individual or group to decide what is good or bad.

BRANCHES OF ETHICS

DESCRIPTIVE ETHICS

1

What do people think is right?

META ETHICS

2

What does 'right' even mean?

NORMATIVE/PRESCRIPTIVE ETHICS

3

How should people act?

APPLIED ETHICS

4

How do we take moral knowledge and put it into practice?

Some do not classify Descriptive Ethics as a distinct branch of Ethics.

DESCRIPTIVE ETHICS



Lawrence Kohlberg

What do people think is right?

- 1 Descriptive ethics, also known as **comparative ethics**, is the study of people's beliefs about morality.
- 2 It is the division of philosophical or general ethics that involves the **observation of the moral decision-making process** with the goal of **describing** the phenomenon.
- 3 As it involves **empirical investigation**, it is a field that is usually investigated by those working in the fields of evolutionary biology, psychology, sociology or anthropology.

*Information that comes from descriptive ethics is also **used in philosophical arguments or in other branches of ethics.***

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

METAETHICS

METAPHYSICAL

OBJECTIVISM

RELATIVISM

INDIVIDUAL

CULTURAL

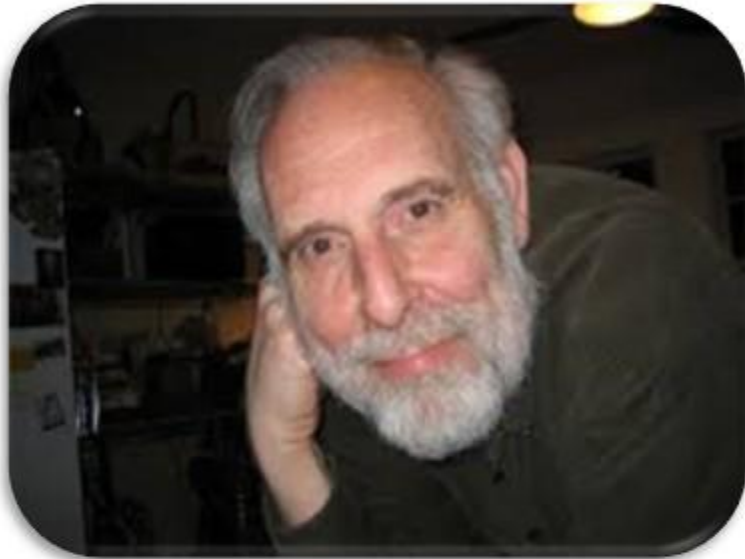
PSYCHOLOGICAL

EGOISM AND
HEDONISM

REASON AND
EMOTION

MALE AND
FEMALE
MORALITY

METAETHICS



Richard Garner

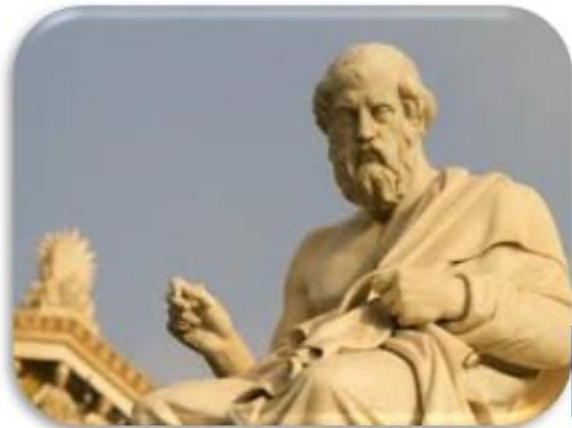
What does 'right' even mean?

- 1 Meta ethics or **analytical ethics** is the study of the **origin and meaning** of ethical concepts.
- 2 It **seeks to understand** the nature of ethical properties, statements, attitudes, and judgments.
- 3 Like Descriptive Ethics, it does **not** attempt to **evaluate specific choices** as being better, worse, good, bad or evil but **asks abstract questions** such as 'What is goodness?' or 'How can we tell what is good from what is bad?'

It mainly covers two issues: (i) Metaphysical and (ii) Psychological

METAETHICS

i) METAPHYSICAL



Plato

OBJECTIVISM

Fredrick
Nietzsche

RELATIVISM

- 1 It involves **discovering** whether moral values are eternal truths that exist in a spirit-like realm, or simply human conventions.
- 2 Proponents of **Objectivism** hold that moral values are objective as they exist beyond subjective human conventions.
- 3 Proponents of **Relativism** argue that moral values are strictly human inventions.
- 4 Two distinct forms of relativism are: **individual relativism** and **cultural relativism**.

METAETHICS

ii) PSYCHOLOGICAL

Thomas
Hobbes

EGOISM

Joseph
Butler

HEDONISM

- 1 Involves the **psychological basis** of our moral judgments and conduct, mainly understanding what motivates us to be moral.
- 2 A view called **psychological egoism** maintains that self-oriented interests ultimately motivate all human actions.
- 3 Another called **psychological hedonism** says that pleasure is the specific driving force behind all of our actions.
- 4 Yet another view called **psychological altruism** maintains that at least some of our actions are motivated by instinctive benevolence.

METAETHICS

ii) PSYCHOLOGICAL

David
Hume

EMOTION

A J
Ayer

REASON

5 Second area of moral psychology involves a dispute concerning the **role of reason** and **emotion** in motivating moral actions.

6 The third area focuses on the **psychological differences between men and women** and their distinct approaches to ethics.

7 This discussion focuses on **two claims**: traditional morality is male-centered, and there is a unique female perspective of the world.

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